IndiGo: Restoring the On-Time Promise

Growth, Reliability and the Cost of Resilience

A different winter ahead

In October 2026, Willie Walsh, newly installed as chief executive officer of IndiGo, faced a decision that could not be deferred until the next disruption. The airline was approaching another winter schedule, when fog, constrained airport capacity and tightly connected aircraft rotations would place renewed pressure on its network. Only ten months earlier, a failure of crew planning and operational control had turned India's biggest airline into the centre of a nationwide travel crisis. The company had restored punctuality, but the failure had exposed a question far larger than whether the next flight would depart on time: how much resilience should a low-cost airline buy, and what might it have to give up to secure it?

Walsh had taken charge on 3 August 2026 following the departure of Pieter Elbers earlier in the year. His appointment brought extensive experience of managing large airlines, yet IndiGo's dilemma was unusually Indian in its scale. It carried nearly two-thirds of the country's domestic air passengers, was pursuing international expansion, and owed much of its competitive advantage to the disciplined use of aircraft, crews and schedules. The same intense utilisation that had helped keep fares affordable had left little space to absorb a regulatory change. The government's inquiry would later identify over-optimisation, inadequate regulatory preparedness, software shortcomings and deficiencies in operational control as the principal causes of the December breakdown. [1, 2]

The immediate task was not simply to recover an on-time-performance score. IndiGo needed a credible operating plan that the aviation regulator, pilots, passengers and shareholders would believe could survive another adverse season. That plan would have to be funded in a year when rising revenue had coexisted with reported losses and external cost shocks. A more conservative schedule, additional reserve pilots and enhanced digital controls could reduce the risk of another breakdown; each also carried a cost or could constrain growth. An aggressive recovery of capacity might preserve network leadership but risk rebuilding precisely the fragility the company was trying to remove.

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***Strict adherence to the data and information provided in the case and its exhibits is mandatory.** Teams must base their analyses, arguments and recommendations exclusively on the information supplied in the case materials. **No external data, updated figures, subsequent developments, additional information or modifications to the provided data will be accepted** during case presentations or discussions.*

The making of a low-cost market leader

IndiGo's proposition had been built around a deliberately narrow promise: competitive fares, on-time flights and a courteous, hassle-free experience. It did not compete primarily through luxury; it competed by making routine air travel dependable at scale. Standardised fleet operations, fast turnarounds, high aircraft utilisation, a dense route network and cost discipline reinforced one another. The proposition was visible not only in marketing but also in operational metrics. A delayed rotation could erode productivity, increase crew hours, disrupt onward connections and weaken the punctuality that had become part of the brand's identity. [3]

Consolidation in Indian aviation strengthened the model's commercial position. In August 2026, IndiGo carried 78.87 lakh domestic passengers and held 65.0% of the domestic market. Air India and Air India Express together held 26.7%, while Akasa Air accounted for 5.5%. IndiGo and the Air India Group thus accounted for more than nine-tenths of domestic traffic. IndiGo's market share had risen to 67.4% in July before easing to 65.0% in August. A dominant domestic presence brought scale economies and network advantage; it also raised the wider economic consequences of a failure. When an airline carrying so many passengers suffers disruption, alternative seats elsewhere in the system may be inadequate. Annexure A summarises the August market position. [4]

The business, meanwhile, was becoming more complex. The fleet had reached 441 aircraft at 31 March 2026 and the airline served 97 domestic and 45 international destinations. It was preparing for a larger international role through longer-range Airbus A321XLR aircraft and a future Airbus A350 fleet. In July 2026, however, IndiGo announced that it would end its damp-lease wide-body arrangements with Norse Atlantic Airways in October and temporarily discontinue its London Heathrow services until its own A350 aircraft arrived; Mumbai–Amsterdam would move to the A321XLR. The adjustment underlined the commercial and operational uncertainty of expanding beyond a mature domestic narrow-body model. [3, 5]

When a regulatory change met an optimised schedule

The warning was embedded in revised Flight Duty Time Limitation (FDTL) regulations intended to reduce pilot fatigue. The rules increased the minimum weekly rest period from 36 to 48 hours, extended the defined night period from midnight–5 a.m. to midnight–6 a.m., and reduced the maximum number of permitted landings during night operations from six to two. These requirements changed the number, mix and location of pilots needed to operate a given schedule. A captain shortage could not be covered merely by having sufficient first officers: qualification, command experience and duty eligibility were distinct constraints. Annexure B sets out the published crew requirement estimates and Annexure D summarises the principal rule changes. [6, 7]

According to figures attributed to IndiGo's submission to the authorities, the requirement for Airbus captains increased from 2,186 under the earlier rules to 2,422 with the revised rules, against 2,357 available captains; first-officer requirements rose from 1,948 to 2,153, against 2,194 available. Read simply, the combined crew deficit appeared modest, but the distribution mattered: there was a reported shortfall of 65 captains and a surplus of 41 first officers. Crew assignment is also a dynamic constraint. Flight duty limits, station locations, reserve availability, sickness, delays, leave and training can make a technically adequate headcount insufficient to operate a particular day's timetable. The published role counts therefore illustrate the constraint; they should not be interpreted as a complete audited manpower model. [7]

IndiGo's winter schedule had been authorised in an environment in which regulators and airlines were already anticipating greater passenger traffic. The published Winter Schedule 2025 provided for 15,014 IndiGo domestic departures per week, up from 13,691 in the comparable Winter Schedule 2024. The increase made the operational transition more demanding. A network designed around narrow buffers could be

efficient on an ordinary day, but a crew shortage at a major base could cascade through multiple rotations. In aviation, lost time is not recovered simply by adding effort: a crew member can reach a legal duty limit, an aircraft can miss an airport slot, and a delay can push subsequent operations into a more restrictive night-duty window. [8]

December 2025: the breakdown

Early December brought the accumulated risks into public view. Flight delays and cancellations spread across IndiGo's network; airports filled with passengers awaiting information, refunds or alternative arrangements. On 4 December, the Ministry of Civil Aviation reported that IndiGo had identified crew-planning challenges associated with the new FDTL norms alongside seasonal weather-related constraints. On 5 December, the ministry temporarily suspended the relevant FDTL orders as an emergency stabilisation measure and required passenger-focused support, including refunds and assistance. These interventions reflected the urgency of restoring the network rather than a judgement that fatigue management was unimportant. [9, 10]

A subsequent government inquiry established a more precise picture than the broad estimates circulating during the crisis. During 3–5 December 2025, IndiGo cancelled 2,507 flights and delayed 1,852, inconveniencing more than three lakh passengers at airports, according to the Ministry of Civil Aviation. Some reporting placed cancellations across the wider first week at approximately 4,500; those figures cover different periods and should not be combined or compared as though they measure the same interval. The narrower government-verified period is used in this case's principal disruption exhibit. [1]

The four-member inquiry examined network planning, crew rostering and supporting software. It described an excessive emphasis on utilisation of crew, aircraft and network resources, leaving inadequate roster buffer and recovery margins. The inquiry also referred to reliance on practices such as dead-heading, aircraft substitutions and extended duty patterns, together with weaknesses in regulatory preparedness and management control. These findings shifted the diagnosis away from a simple explanation of bad weather or isolated employee shortages. The operating system itself had failed to absorb a known change in its regulatory environment. [1]

The distinction mattered for leadership. A customer may forgive a delay caused by heavy fog; a network-wide breakdown associated with preventable planning deficiencies raises questions about whether the airline can be trusted to deliver its basic promise. The burden was even greater for travellers on routes offering limited alternatives. By the time normal schedules were restored, the incident had become a test of accountability across functions rather than a problem confined to rostering software.

From service failure to governance test

On 17 January 2026, the Ministry of Civil Aviation published the findings and enforcement action. DGCA imposed a ₹22.20-crore penalty comprising ₹1.80 crore in one-time systemic penalties and ₹20.40 crore attributed to specified continuing non-compliance over 68 days. The regulator also required a separate ₹50-crore bank guarantee linked to a structured reform programme. The guarantee was not an additional fine: its release was to depend on independent verification of corrective steps. Regulatory action included a caution to the then chief executive, a warning to the accountable manager and action concerning senior operational officials. [1]

The reform scheme, described as the IndiGo Systemic Reform Assurance Scheme (ISRAS), created four monitored commitments: leadership and governance; manpower planning, rostering and fatigue-risk management; digital systems and operational resilience; and board-level oversight with sustained compliance. The stages were associated with guarantee amounts of ₹10 crore, ₹15 crore, ₹15 crore and ₹10

crore, respectively. The structure effectively turned operational recovery into a measurable governance programme. It also limited management's freedom to describe a return to normal punctuality as sufficient evidence of success. Annexure E summarises the regulatory findings, financial consequences and reform pillars. [1]

Passenger remedies became another test. The government required prompt refunds, supported passengers through monitoring arrangements and directed the airline to provide specified compensation. DGCA subsequently recorded that IndiGo had also extended a ₹10,000 "Gesture of Care" voucher, valid for twelve months, for qualifying flights cancelled or delayed by over three hours during 3–5 December. From the airline's perspective, the voucher was a gesture toward repairing trust; from a traveller's perspective, whether it could substitute for the inconvenience experienced was a different question. The larger brand problem was that reliability, not compensation, had been the reason many customers chose IndiGo in the first place. [1, 11]

Recovery in the market, uncertainty in the brand

By August 2026, the immediate operational picture looked markedly better. Published DGCA-based data showed IndiGo with 91.0% on-time performance at the ten major airports used in the measure, compared with 90.5% for Akasa Air and 83.9% for the Air India Group. Yet punctuality and trust are not identical measures. A large market share after a disruption could reflect renewed customer confidence, but it could also reflect limited alternative capacity, strong network coverage or price. Restoring performance was necessary; demonstrating that the system could consistently withstand a shock was the harder challenge. [4]

The pressure to regain control of the customer experience extended beyond aircraft departures. Reuters reported that IndiGo experienced a second booking-platform problem within a week in August 2026, temporarily affecting its website and customer access. These incidents were distinct from the December crew-rostering breakdown and should not be assumed to have the same cause. They nevertheless expanded the meaning of reliability: passengers expected not only safe and punctual flights but also functioning digital reservations, timely information and usable recovery options when plans changed. [12]

In a low-cost model, brand expenditure alone could not solve these problems. An advertising campaign might remind travellers of past punctuality, but if the underlying operations were vulnerable, a renewed failure would render the communication counterproductive. IndiGo's management faced a choice about how explicitly to acknowledge the breakdown, what operational guarantees could credibly be made, and which customer metrics should be disclosed to demonstrate improvement. The most convincing brand investment might be invisible to customers: reserve capacity, stronger crew controls, station-level recovery teams and more conservative scheduling.

The economics of resilience

The question became more difficult because the airline's reported financial results did not provide a simple picture of cash generation or distress. Consolidated revenue from operations rose from approximately ₹68,904 crore in FY 2023–24 to ₹80,803 crore in FY 2024–25 and ₹84,962 crore in FY 2025–26. Yet consolidated profit after tax fell from ₹8,172 crore to ₹7,258 crore and then swung to a loss of ₹2,394 crore. The 2025–26 loss, however, incorporated substantial foreign-exchange and exceptional effects. IndiGo separately reported a profit of approximately ₹7,503 crore excluding those effects. The proper inference was not that the airline's core flight operations had necessarily lost an equivalent amount in cash, but that growth, volatile external costs and reported profitability were increasingly difficult to reconcile. Annexure C contains the consolidated financial and operating series and their sources. [3, 13, 14]

The operating figures nevertheless showed a capacity and efficiency tension. In FY 2025–26, available seat kilometres increased by 9.5% while passenger numbers grew by 4.0%, from 118.6 million to 123.4 million. Passenger load factor declined from 86.0% to 84.4%. EBITDAR fell from ₹21,252 crore to ₹15,089 crore, with margin contracting from 26.3% to 17.8%. The company's own results identified foreign-exchange, labour-law effects and external operating conditions, including the broader geopolitical environment, as significant contributors. The December disruption occurred within that period, but the information publicly available did not permit management students to quantify its standalone contribution to the annual loss without additional assumptions. [3]

The quarter ended June 2026 made the trade-off more immediate. Revenue from operations grew from ₹20,496 crore a year earlier to ₹24,584 crore, but EBITDAR declined from ₹5,739 crore to ₹3,833 crore and a ₹2,176-crore quarterly profit turned into a ₹238-crore loss. Fuel-cost escalation, rupee weakness and route constraints linked to Middle East developments weighed on results. At 30 June 2026, the company reported total cash of about ₹52,885 crore, comprising roughly ₹39,039 crore of free cash and ₹13,846 crore of restricted cash. The distinction matters: the total balance could not be treated as unrestricted funding available for new crew or technology investment. [15]

Additional reserve pilots, greater schedule slack or more resilient airport operations would increase visible costs or reduce utilisation. But the price of a major disruption included lost flight revenue, passenger accommodation, refunds and compensation, longer-term demand effects, staff fatigue, regulatory intervention and managerial attention. Some of those costs appeared in company accounts; others would have to be estimated through scenarios. A defensible decision therefore required more than comparing the salary cost of reserve crews with the cost of cancelled tickets. It required an assessment of low-probability, high-impact network failure and of the value of protecting a brand whose main asset was reliability.

Scaling abroad while repairing at home

IndiGo's international ambitions complicated the resource-allocation choice. A321XLR aircraft offered longer-range narrow-body possibilities, while the future A350 programme signalled an ambition to serve long-haul markets. These services could diversify revenue and strengthen the airline's global position, but they also exposed the company to unfamiliar airport systems, international airspace changes, aircraft types, long duty patterns and potentially different service expectations. The July 2026 adjustment to the Norse damp-lease operation illustrated that fleet strategy had to remain responsive to real-world operating conditions. [5]

A management team could respond by protecting the domestic core first and slowing expansion until the operating system was proven resilient. It could instead segregate parts of the international growth plan from the narrow-body domestic network, using different operating structures and risk buffers. A third approach might sustain the expansion trajectory while spending more aggressively on people, technology and contingency capacity. Each approach imposed costs: slower growth might sacrifice scarce opportunities, while accelerated investment might compress margins in a year of financial pressure.

Organisational culture was another constraint. In an airline built to reward resource productivity, reserve capacity can appear wasteful until an adverse event occurs. Changing the model would require revised incentives, decision rights and performance dashboards. The board could no longer rely on punctuality alone as an adequate indication of operational health. A consistently green on-time dashboard might coexist with unsustainable crew rosters, poor fatigue indicators or a fragile concentration of connections at a few hubs. For this reason, DGCA's requirements for board oversight and verified reforms had strategic implications beyond narrow compliance.

The decision before the winter schedule

As October 2026 progressed, Walsh and IndiGo's operating leadership had to frame a 24-month plan credible enough to reach beyond a single successful season. The immediate choices involved staffing and reserve coverage, night-flight intensity, disruption recovery capability and whether growth assumptions should be revised until the roster system had been stress-tested. They also involved accountability: who should own a network-wide early-warning indicator, what must be escalated to the board, and when should the airline proactively reduce published capacity rather than wait for cancellations?

For passengers, the relevant outcome was straightforward: a ticket should mean a dependable journey and clear assistance when exceptions occurred. For regulators, the standard was demonstrable compliance with duty-rest rules and sustained corrective action. For shareholders, the business needed to retain the economics that had made IndiGo successful. For pilots and operations staff, resilience could not be defined as requiring additional effort from an already constrained workforce. These interests overlapped, but they were not identical.

The board needed a recommendation before the winter operating cycle intensified. Should IndiGo accept lower aircraft and crew utilisation in exchange for a larger operating buffer; invest in data-led scheduling and recovery while maintaining network intensity; or sequence a broader redesign, temporarily moderating growth until new controls were proven? What combination of people, process, digital systems and governance would be sufficient—and what evidence, over the next 24 months, would demonstrate that IndiGo had not merely regained its punctuality ranking but rebuilt the system behind its on-time promise?

Annexures

Annexure A. India domestic scheduled-airline market and punctuality, August 2026

Carrier / group	Passengers (lakh)	Domestic market share	On-time performance
IndiGo	78.87	65.0%	91.0%
Air India + Air India Express	32.32	26.7%	83.9%
Akasa Air	6.68	5.5%	90.5%
SpiceJet	1.40	1.2%	17.9%
Alliance Air	Not shown	Not shown	71.8%

Source: DGCA August 2026 domestic traffic and on-time performance statistics, as reported by NDTV Profit, 23 September 2026 [4]. OTP corresponds to the reported ten-major-airport measure. Market shares are rounded; airlines not listed in the table account for the remainder. "Not shown" does not mean zero.

Annexure A2. IndiGo domestic market-share trajectory, selected months (%)

August 2025	May 2026	June 2026	July 2026	August 2026
64.2	64.9	66.3	67.4	65.0

Source: Selected monthly DGCA figures cited in the supplied AIMA challenge and corroborated for July/August by DGCA-based reporting [4]. Earlier months are retained as reported in the supplied challenge; use the monthly DGCA series for a full audit. July, not June, is the highest percentage shown in this selected series.

Annexure B. Airbus cockpit-crew demand and availability after FDTL changes, late 2025 (persons)

Crew role	Earlier requirement	Revised requirement	Available	Revised less available

Crew role	Earlier requirement	Revised requirement	Available	Revised less available
Captains (P1)	2,186	2,422	2,357	65 short
First officers (P2)	1,948	2,153	2,194	41 surplus
Total	4,134	4,575	4,551	24 short overall

Source: Crew requirement figures attributed to IndiGo's regulatory submission in Hindustan Times, 4 December 2025 [7]. Calculations in the final column by AIMA–ICRC. Role-by-role availability is more meaningful than the net total because first officers cannot substitute for captains. This is a reported point-in-time estimate, not a verified full crew-roster dataset.

Annexure C1. InterGlobe Aviation Limited: consolidated financial performance, FY 2023–24 to FY 2025–26 (₹ crore unless specified)

Particulars	FY 2023–24	FY 2024–25	FY 2025–26
Revenue from operations	68,904.34	80,802.90	84,961.90
Other income	2,326.82	3,295.30	4,551.50
Total income	71,231.16	84,098.20	89,513.40
Profit / (loss) before tax	8,049.31	7,593.40	(1,960.50)
Profit / (loss) after tax	8,172.47	7,258.40	(2,393.60)
Basic EPS (₹)	211.84	187.93	(61.88)

Sources: InterGlobe Aviation FY 2023–24 consolidated annual report [13]; FY 2025–26 consolidated results and FY 2024–25 comparatives [3, 14]. ₹ crore figures converted from company-reported ₹ million by dividing by 10; figures rounded to two decimals. EPS as reported. Parentheses denote a loss. The FY 2023–24 "other income" here is ₹2,326.82 crore from the audited annual report, correcting the rounded number in the original challenge.

Annexure C2. InterGlobe Aviation: consolidated operating performance, FY 2024–25 and FY 2025–26

Operating measure	FY 2024–25	FY 2025–26
Passengers carried (million)	118.6	123.4
Available seat kilometres (billion)	157.5	172.4
Revenue passenger kilometres (billion)	135.4	145.5
Load factor	86.0%	84.4%
Passenger yield (₹/km)	5.15	5.06
EBITDAR (₹ crore)	21,252.0	15,089.2
EBITDAR margin	26.3%	17.8%

Source: IndiGo FY 2025–26 earnings release, 29 May 2026, full-year operating and profitability metrics [3]. Passenger, ASK and RPK counts include non-scheduled operations as company reported. Yield is ₹ per passenger-kilometre; FY 2024–25 value of ₹5.15 is directly reported, not an estimate.

Annexure C3. InterGlobe Aviation: consolidated first-quarter financial and operating comparison (Q1 ended 30 June)

Operating measure	Q1 FY 2025–26	Q1 FY 2026–27
Revenue from operations (₹ crore)	20,496.3	24,584.1
Total income (₹ crore)	21,542.6	25,614.1
EBITDAR (₹ crore)	5,738.6	3,832.5
EBITDAR margin	28.0%	15.6%
Profit / (loss) after tax (₹ crore)	2,176.3	(238.0)
Passenger load factor	84.6%	83.3%

Operating measure	Q1 FY 2025–26	Q1 FY 2026–27
Closing aircraft fleet	416	432

Sources: InterGlobe Aviation 23 July 2026 NSE consolidated filing and accompanying earnings release [15]; IndiGo Q1 FY 2025–26 earnings release [16]. Values are rounded to one decimal where appropriate. "Closing fleet" is at 30 June in the respective year, not average available aircraft. FY 2026–27 quarterly results are unaudited.

Annexure C4. FY 2025–26 reported versus adjusted earnings: understanding the loss

Measure	FY 2025–26 (₹ crore)	Interpretation
Reported consolidated PAT	(2,393.6)	Reported net loss
PAT excluding foreign-exchange and exceptional effects	7,502.5	Company-defined adjusted profit
EBITDAR	15,089.2	Reported operating measure, includes forex impact
EBITDAR excluding foreign-exchange impact	23,188.9	Company-defined adjusted operating measure

Source: IndiGo FY 2025–26 earnings release [3]. The adjusted figures are company-defined non-GAAP-style analytical measures and are not a substitute for reported consolidated PAT. These differences must not be attributed solely to the December 2025 disruptions.

Annexure D. Selected Flight Duty Time Limitation rule changes relevant to the 2025 disruption

Dimension	Earlier provision	Revised provision
Minimum weekly rest	36 hours	48 hours
Night period	00:00–05:00	00:00–06:00
Maximum landings on night operations	6	2

Source: Ministry of Civil Aviation / Press Information Bureau statement on revised FDTL regulations [6]. The exhibit simplifies selected provisions; it is not the complete Civil Aviation Requirement and is not a substitute for a regulatory-compliance assessment. Implementation timing and temporary December 2025 relief are discussed in the case [9, 10].

Annexure E1. Officially documented operational disruption, 3–5 December 2025

Measure	Officially reported figure
Cancelled IndiGo flights	2,507
Delayed IndiGo flights	1,852
Passengers inconvenienced at airports	More than 300,000

Source: Ministry of Civil Aviation, "Indigo Flight Disruptions—December 2025: Findings, Enforcement Action and Systemic Reforms," 17 January 2026 [1]. These figures cover 3–5 December; wider first-week media aggregates use a different period and are not substituted here.

Annexure E2. DGCA enforcement and guaranteed reform framework, January 2026

Measure / reform pillar	Amount (₹ crore)	Nature / condition
One-time systemic penalties	1.80	Financial penalty
Continued non-compliance penalty	20.40	Financial penalty
Total financial penalty	22.20	Sum of two components
ISRAS: leadership and governance	10.00	Guarantee tranche; DGCA verification
ISRAS: manpower, rostering and fatigue controls	15.00	Guarantee tranche; DGCA verification
ISRAS: digital systems and resilience	15.00	Guarantee tranche; DGCA

Measure / reform pillar	Amount (₹ crore)	Nature / condition
		verification
ISRAS: board oversight / sustained compliance	10.00	Guarantee tranche; DGCA verification
Total bank guarantee	50.00	Separate from fine; release conditional

Source: Ministry of Civil Aviation / DGCA enforcement announcement of 17 January 2026 [1]. The ₹50-crore bank guarantee is security linked to independently verified reforms, not an additional imposed fine. Milestone release periods in the announcement range from three to fifteen months.

Annexure F. Management control measures for the proposed 24-month resilience plan

Decision dimension	Measures participants can evaluate	Public baseline available
Crew and roster	Captains by base, legal roster buffer, reserve utilisation, fatigue alerts	Reported captain gap: 65 in late 2025 [7]
Reliability	On-time performance, cancellations, time to stabilise after disruption	91.0% August 2026 OTP [4]
Network	Night-flight exposure, peak hub concentration, planned schedule slack	Not publicly disclosed in case-ready detail
Customer	Refund turnaround, complaints per 10,000, service recovery satisfaction	Case does not establish a verified series
Economics	CASK, EBITDAR margin, disruption cost versus reserve cost	FY26 EBITDAR margin 17.8% [3]
Governance	FDTL exceptions, ISRAS milestones, board escalation triggers	ISRAS framework disclosed [1]

Sources: [1], [3], [4], [7]. This is an ANALYTICAL EXHIBIT devised for the competition, not a company-released KPI dashboard. Blank baseline items are intentionally not estimated or presented as historical actuals. Teams should make and label assumptions where necessary.

Source notes and verification record

References are numbered for use in the running case and annexures. Primary company or government releases have been preferred wherever available; secondary reporting is identified when the primary DGCA dataset or exact management submission was not independently retrievable. All sources were accessed or checked for this case in October 2026.

[1] Ministry of Civil Aviation / PIB (17 January 2026), "Indigo Flight Disruptions—December 2025: Findings, Enforcement Action and Systemic Reforms." https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2215709&lang=2&reg=48

[2] IndiGo (3 August 2026), "Willie Walsh Takes Charge as Chief Executive Officer of IndiGo." https://www.goindigo.in/press-releases/willie-walsh-takes-charge-as-chief-executive-officer-of-indigo.html

[3] IndiGo (29 May 2026), "IndiGo Reported Its Fourth Quarter and Fiscal Year 2026 Results." https://www.goindigo.in/press-releases/indigo-fy2026-capacity-and-income-growth.html

[4] NDTV Profit (23 September 2026), DGCA-based report: "IndiGo Again Tops Domestic Aviation Market With 65% Share in August." https://www.ndtvprofit.com/india/indigo-again-tops-domestic-aviation-with-65-market-share-in-august-air-india-group-second-spice-jet-akasa-air-12085153

[5] IndiGo press-release index (31 July 2026), notice of discontinuation of Norse damp-lease operations and long-haul service changes. https://www.goindigo.in/press-releases.html

[6] Ministry of Civil Aviation / PIB (8 January 2024), "Revised FDTL Regulations" key highlights. https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleaseIframePage.aspx?PRID=1994183&lang=2&reg=48

[7] Hindustan Times (4 December 2025), "IndiGo admits planning gaps behind roster chaos," including captain and first-officer figures reported from company submission. https://www.hindustantimes.com/india-news/indigo-admits-planning-gaps-behind-roster-chaos-seeks-time-till-feb-10-to-stabilise-101764866153378.html

[8] Ministry of Civil Aviation / PIB (24 October 2025), "Winter Schedule 2025 of Scheduled Domestic Airlines." https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2182189&lang=2&reg=3

[9] Ministry of Civil Aviation / PIB (4 December 2025), official meeting regarding IndiGo operational disruptions. https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2199130&lang=1&reg=3

[10] Ministry of Civil Aviation / PIB (5 December 2025), ministerial statement on emergency FDTL relief and passenger arrangements. https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2199455&lang=1&reg=1

[11] Ministry of Civil Aviation / PIB (6 December 2025), passenger refund protection direction. https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2199762&lang=2&reg=3

[12] Reuters (21 August 2026), "India's IndiGo systems restored after booking problems for second time this week." https://www.reuters.com/world/india/website-indias-indigo-blocks-some-bookings-weeks-second-disruption-2026-08-21/

[13] InterGlobe Aviation Limited, Annual Report FY 2023–24, consolidated financial information (NSE archive). https://nsearchives.nseindia.com/annual_reports/AR_24753_INDIGO_2023_2024_31072024222919.pdf

[14] InterGlobe Aviation Limited, FY 2025–26 consolidated audited filing (NSE integrated Ind AS results). https://nsearchives.nseindia.com/corporate/ixbrl/INTEGRATED_FILING_INDAS_164318_29052026221421_iXBRL_WEB.html

[15] InterGlobe Aviation Limited, unaudited consolidated results for quarter ended 30 June 2026 (NSE, filed 23 July 2026); original press release and presentation referenced through company investor-relations index. https://nsearchives.nseindia.com/corporate/ixbrl/INTEGRATED_FILING_INDAS_177365_23072026174231_iXBRL_WEB.html

[16] IndiGo (30 July 2025), first-quarter FY 2025–26 results and operational metrics. https://www.goindigo.in/press-releases/indigo-releases-q1-financial-results-of-fy-2026.html

Editorial and data-use note

Case narrative: no invented quotations or private executive conversations. Case decision date: October 2026. All annexure periods are expressly identified; 2025–26 full-year results and July 2026 Q1 results are available by the decision date. The absence of independently verifiable operational metrics is not filled with fictitious figures. The source challenge's broad "over a million stranded" formulation, unsupported percentage estimate for crew-buffer undercount, and ambiguous "record June 2026 share" characterisation were not carried into the revised case as established facts. The original chart heading "data supplied by organiser" has been replaced by source-specific captions. Financial results are consolidated, rather than standalone, where expressly indicated.